ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

UNIZIK Fresher Survival Guide: Registration, Campus and First Semester

What to do in your first weeks, in the order that actually matters

CAMPUS LIFE

Campus Life

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Free to download. No fee, no payment step, no watermark.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

First semester is easier when you know the sequence: documents, registration, course allocation, departmental orientation and the small habits that prevent avoidable problems. This pack is a practical checklist, not a rumour collection.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Assemble the documents and steps needed for registration.
- Plan the first two weeks to avoid deadline pressure.
- Locate the key offices and know which problems they solve.
- Build habits that protect your academic standing from day one.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

The first two weeks

Registration delays cause stress later. Move early and keep copies of everything.

1. Confirm your admission status and collect the required documents listed by the university.
2. Complete screening and pay approved fees through official channels only.
3. Complete course registration and confirm your course list with your department.
4. Attend departmental and faculty orientation; note deadlines and contact persons.
5. Meet your course rep and level adviser, and join the official class channel.
6. Locate the library, ICT centre, health centre and your lecture venues before the first week ends.

> **Official channels only**
> Pay fees through the university's official platform. Anyone who offers to 'fast-track' registration for cash is a risk, not a shortcut.

Know the offices

Most first-year problems are resolved faster when you go to the right office with the right documents.

- Departmental office: course registration issues, results, lecturer contacts.
- Faculty office: academic records and faculty-level approvals.
- Bursary: fee payment confirmation and receipts.
- ICT centre: portal access and login problems.
- Health centre: medical attention and sick notes.
- Student affairs: hostel matters, welfare and student organisations.

Habits that protect your semester

Small routines prevent most avoidable academic problems.

- Attend lectures and sign attendance where required.
- Keep receipts, registration slips and screenshots in one folder.
- Submit assignments on time and keep a copy.
- Check official notice boards and portals weekly.
- Learn the course outline and assessment weightings early.
- Ask questions in class; anonymity disappears quickly at university.

The first three weeks decide a lot

Registration, course allocation, timetables, hostel allocation and identity documents all happen in a compressed period, and each has a queue. Students who finish registration early have time to attend lectures; those who leave it late spend the first month chasing signatures and miss the material that everything else builds on.

Know your documents before you need them: admission letter, result slips, birth certificate or age declaration, local government identification, passport photographs, and payment receipts. Keep both physical copies and photographs on your phone and in cloud storage. Most registration crises are a missing photocopy, not a missing qualification.

Find four places in your first week: your department's notice board, the faculty office, the library, and the health centre. These are the four you will need in an emergency, and none of them is the one you will be told about most loudly.

The unglamorous essentials

Read the student handbook once. It contains the regulations that will decide disputes later: attendance requirements, examination rules, grading, carry-over, and disciplinary procedures. Students who have never read it are surprised by rules that were published before they arrived.

Build a small margin: a little money set aside, a printed copy of your timetable, a charged power bank, and one person in your department who answers your messages. Margin is what turns a bad day into an inconvenience rather than a crisis.

Protect your sleep in the first month. New students lose sleep to noise, anxiety and irregular meals, then conclude they cannot cope academically. Most of what looks like an academic problem in week four is a sleep and food problem.

> **Ask early, ask specifically**
> The department officer who has answered the same vague question forty times will answer a precise one. "My course form shows GST 103 but my timetable shows GST 107 - which is correct?" gets help.

People, money and boundaries

Join one organisation, not five. A departmental society, a professional body chapter or a volunteer group gives you information, contacts and a reason to be on campus that is not an examination. Five memberships give you five sets of meetings and no depth.

Money leaves quickly in the first semester because of setup costs. Track spending for four weeks and you will see the pattern. Set a weekly figure rather than a monthly one, since a monthly budget is exhausted in the first ten days by almost everyone who tries it.

Set boundaries before you need them. Lending money you cannot lose, joining a group because leaving would be awkward, or accepting an arrangement you have not understood are all decisions better made in advance than under pressure.

WORKED EXAMPLES

Do it once, slowly

These are not model answers to copy. They show the reasoning a strong student would use, step by step, so you can repeat the process on a question you have not seen.

1. A first-week checklist

You arrive on Monday with an admission letter.

1. Day 1: confirm department, collect and complete registration forms, scan all documents.
2. Day 2: pay approved fees only through official channels, keep receipts, verify course registration.
3. Day 3: locate lecture venues and copy the timetable into your phone and a paper copy.
4. Day 4: introduce yourself to your course adviser and one class representative.
5. Day 5: visit the library and health centre; note opening hours.
6. Day 6: read the student handbook sections on attendance and examinations.

> **What to carry forward**
> Do the bureaucratic work in the first week so the semester belongs to you.

2. Handling a bureaucratic dead end

An officer says your file is not on the list and sends you away.

1. Write down the officer's name and the exact statement made.
2. Ask what document would resolve it, rather than arguing.
3. Check whether the same process exists at another window or online.
4. Escalate to the course adviser or department head with the specific question.
5. Keep a dated note of each visit and what you were told.
6. Follow up in writing where possible so there is a record.

> **What to carry forward**
> Ask for the missing document, not for sympathy, and keep a written record.

EXAM TECHNIQUE

Questions with model answers

Written in the shape your course is usually examined, with the marking logic spelled out. Attempt each one under time before you read the outline.

Q1. List the documents a fresher should keep available and explain why duplicates matter.

10 marks

1. Admission letter, results, age or birth documentation, identification, photographs, receipts.
2. Physical and digital copies.
3. Duplicates prevent delays at each registration stage.

Q2. Why should a new student read the student handbook in the first week?

10 marks

1. It states attendance, examination, grading and disciplinary rules.
2. Rules are enforced whether or not they were read.
3. Early knowledge prevents avoidable loss of a semester.

REFERENCE

Glossary

Use these definitions in your own sentences; a copied definition rarely earns full marks.

Matriculation. The formal enrolment of a student into the university.

Course adviser. The staff member who guides a student's course selection.

Course registration. The formal enrolment in specific courses for a semester.

Carry-over course. A failed course that must be retaken.

CGPA. Cumulative grade point average across all completed semesters.

Student handbook. The document stating institutional rules and procedures.

Class representative. A student who liaises between the class and lecturers.

Faculty officer. The administrative officer handling faculty records.

Study leave. Approved absence from study for a defined reason.

Transcript. The official record of a student's courses and grades.

Your four-week plan

Week 1 - Land

Registration.

- Complete registration and scan documents.
- Locate four key offices.
- Copy the timetable.

Week 2 - Learn the rules

Handbook.

- Read attendance and examination rules.
- Note grading and carry-over policy.
- Meet your course adviser.

Week 3 - Routine

Habits.

- Attend every lecture.
- Set a weekly spending figure.
- Join one organisation.

Week 4 - Review

Adjust.

- Check you are registered for all courses.
- Review sleep and meals.
- List three problems and one action each.

Where to read more

Entry-level texts you can find in the university library or a departmental reading list. Confirm editions with your lecturer.

- Your university student handbook.
- The department handbook for your programme.
- The academic calendar for the session.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. List five documents commonly required for fresher registration.

Answer: Admission letter, O-level result, JAMB result or admission slip, birth certificate or age declaration, and passport photographs. Requirements vary, so confirm with your department.

2. Why should you keep receipts and screenshots?

Answer: They are evidence if a payment or registration is later disputed or not reflected in the system.

3. Which office handles portal login problems?

Answer: The university ICT centre, sometimes with support from your department.

4. Why meet your course rep early?

Answer: They relay schedule changes, deadlines and class information, and can direct you to the right staff.

5. What should you do if a registration deadline is missed?

Answer: Go to your department immediately, explain the situation in person, and ask about the official remedy rather than relying on informal fixes.

Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] Assemble all admission and registration documents in one folder.
- [ ] Complete screening and fee payment through official channels.
- [ ] Confirm your registered courses with your department.
- [ ] Attend orientation and record key contacts.
- [ ] Save the department, faculty and ICT contacts in your phone.
- [ ] Walk your timetable route once before lectures begin.
- [ ] Create a receipts folder on your phone and in hard copy.

Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

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YOUR WORKSPACE

Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

Three ideas I can now explain without notes:

A question I still cannot answer:

For my lecturer or course rep:

Next revision action and date: